

Course Outline

DESIGN ENTREPRENEURSHIP

Course Code: BDSE34606

Semester VI

B.Des (Hons)

Communication

Design: 2025-26

3 Credits

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Brief Description and Relevance of the Course

Design Entrepreneurship is an advanced, practice-focused module that helps students understand how design becomes a catalyst for business innovation. Learners develop competencies in opportunity mapping, value proposition design, market analysis, branding, prototyping, and venture strategy.

Through project-based learning, agile sprint cycles, industry interactions, and real-world founder insights, students build and pitch a fully developed early-stage design-led startup.

The course is aligned with the Polaris Transformation Framework, integrating Industry Connect, Peer Learning, ERS (Ethics, Responsibility, Sustainability), Interdisciplinary Collaboration, Microcampus Opportunities, International Exposure (Virtual Feedback Sessions).

Programme LOs Addressed:

PLO	Definition
PLO 1 – Visual Communication	Visual Communication: Demonstrate ability to create effective visual communication through various media, including print, digital, and interactive formats.
PLO 2 – Brand Identity Development	Develop strong brand identities through visual language and messaging.
PLO 3 – User Experience (UX) Design	Understand user-centered design principles and create user-friendly interfaces and experiences.
PLO 4 – Research and Analysis	Conduct thorough research to inform design decisions and identify target audiences.
PLO 5 - Storytelling and Narrative	Effectively communicate ideas and messages through visual storytelling and narrative design.

Course LOs

Course LO	Mapping to PLO
CLO 1: Demonstrate a thorough understanding of the key principles and practices essential for successful design entrepreneurship.	PLO1 & PLO 2
CLO 2: Develop detailed and strategic business plans specifically tailored for design startups.	PLO1, PLO2 & PLO 3
CLO 3: Apply innovative and creative thinking to generate unique design solutions and viable business ideas.	PLO3 & PLO5
CLO 4: Acquire practical skills and knowledge necessary for the successful management and growth of a design startup.	PLO3, PLO4 & PLO5

Prerequisites: NIL

Reference/ Reading Material Recommended

Code	Textbook/Article/Report Name	Edition/Year/Link	CLO Mapped
R1	The Lean Startup: How Today's Entrepreneurs Use Continuous Innovation to Create Radically Successful Businesses	Eric Ries, 2011	CLO 1, CLO 2
R2	Creative Confidence: Unleashing the Creative Potential Within Us All	Tom Kelley and David Kelley, 1st Edition	CLO 1, CLO 3
R3	Design a Better Business: New Tools, Skills, and Mindset for Strategy and Innovation	Patrick Van Der Pijl, Justin Lokitz, and Lisa Kay Solomon, 1st Edition.	CLO 2, CLO 3
R4	Business Model Generation: A Handbook for Visionaries, Game Changers, and Challengers	Alexander Osterwalder and Yves Pigneur, 1st Edition	CLO 2, CLO 3, CLO 4
R5	Zero to One: Notes on Startups, or How to Build the Future	Peter Thiel and Blake Masters, 1st Edition.	CLO 3, CLO 4
R6	The Art of Innovation: Lessons in Creativity from IDEO, America's Leading Design Firm	Tom Kelley and Jonathan Littman, 1st Edition	CLO 1, CLO 2
R7	The Start-up Owner's Manual: The Step-By-Step Guide for Building a Great Company	Blank & Dorf	CLO 2, CLO 4
R8	Business Model Generation	Alexander Osterwalder	CLO 3, CLO 4

Session-Wise Topics and Reading/References					
Sn.	Topic	Session Intended Learning Outcome	Pedagogy	CIL O	Reading Material Code
1	Introduction to Design Entrepreneurship	Foundations, creative economy, entrepreneurial mindset	Lecture + Case Study	1	R1
2	Creative Enterprise Ecosystems & Opportunity Spaces	Emerging markets and opportunity identification	Case Study	1	R1
3	Opportunity Mapping & Weak Signals	Workshop	Lecture + Activity	2	R2
4	Unmet Needs & Insight Clustering	Mapping user tensions and opportunity areas	Activity	2	R2
5	User Research for Startup Ideas	Research methods for early-stage venture discovery	Lecture	2	R3
6	Translating Research into Opportunity Statements	Turning insights into actionable startup opportunities	Workshop	2	R3
7	Value Proposition Design	Building value narratives and user benefit mapping	Lecture + Activity	2	R2
8	Stakeholder Mapping & Early Validation	Identifying stakeholders and validation flow	Case Activity	2	R3
9	Business Models for Creative Ventures	Revenue models, pricing, customer segments	Lecture	3	R6

10	Design-Led Brand Building & Visual Narrative	How storytelling shapes venture identity	Lecture + Case Study	3,4	R3
11	Visual Communication Systems for Startup Identity	Creating visual frameworks and brand assets	Activity	3,4	R3
12	Market Mapping & Customer Segmentation	Understanding markets, channels, audiences	Lecture	4	R5
13	GTM Strategy, Traction Models & Scaling Pathways	Growth funnels, outreach pathways, scaling methods	Lecture	4	R5
14	Rapid Prototyping & MVP Development	MVP logic and quick prototyping	Workshop	3	R8
15	User Testing, Feedback & Refinement	User feedback cycles and iterative improvements	Activity	3	R8
16	Pitch Structure, Narrative & Deck Development	Narrative crafting and pitch preparation	Lecture	4	R4
17	Final Pitch Jury	Presentation of venture pitches	Jury	4	R1-R8

Performance Evaluation Components for the Course

Session No.	Marks	Evaluation Form	CILO
Continuous Evaluation/Internal Assessment			
2-4	15	Opportunity Mapping (Appendix A)	1,2
5-7	15	MVP Sprint (Appendix B)	2,3
8-12	30	Design Venture Project (Appendix C)	2,3,4
13-15	40	Final Pitch Deck Jury (Appendix D)	4

AI Assessment

Session No.	Marks	Evaluation Form	AI Assessment Level	Scale Name	CILO	Outcome Measured
2–4	15	Appendix A: Opportunity Mapping	No AI	Scale 1	CILO 1–2	Insight creation & opportunity interpretation
5–7	15	Appendix B: MVP Sprint	No AI	Scale 1	CILO 2–3	Prototyping, feasibility, MVP logic
8–12	30	Appendix C: Design Venture Project	No AI	Scale 1	CILO 2–4	Strategic venture building
End Term	40	Appendix D: Final Pitch Deck Jury	No AI	Scale 1	CILO 4	Professional presentation & pitch ability

Evaluation Components & CILO Alignment

The evaluation structure for this course follows a **progressive venture-building model**, ensuring that each assessment component directly contributes to the achievement of the Course Intended Learning Outcomes (CILOs).

The progression intentionally mirrors the **real-world entrepreneurial journey**—beginning with opportunity discovery (CILO 1), moving into insight generation and value proposition design (CILO 2), advancing into business model development and prototyping (CILO 3), expanding into strategic venture planning and feasibility (CILO 4), and culminating in professional, investor-grade pitching (CILO 5).

This structured flow supports **Project Based Learning, Agile Sprint Cycles, Reflective Practice**, and **Portfolio-Oriented Assessment**, allowing learners to integrate conceptual thinking, business strategy, design execution, and professional communication into a cohesive entrepreneurial practice.

Evaluation Component	CILO Alignment	Description
Opportunity Mapping (Appendix A)	CILO 1–2	Evaluates the student’s ability to identify early signals, interpret trends, analyze user pain points, and synthesize meaningful opportunity spaces using design and business logic.
MVP Sprint (Appendix B)	CILO 2-3	Assesses the development of value propositions, basic business logic, rapid prototyping, and the student’s ability to create feasible MVP solutions aligned with user needs and startup constraints.
Design Venture Project(Appendix C)	CILO 2–4	Measures strategic thinking, business model creation, venture articulation, scalability analysis, prototype refinement, and the ability to integrate research, design, and entrepreneurship into a functional startup concept.
Final Jury Investor Pitch Deck Presentation (Appendix D)	CILO 4	Evaluates professional communication, narrative clarity, investor-style deck creation, articulation of business viability, and the student’s ability to pitch their venture with confidence, structure, and persuasive reasoning.

Rubrics

CLO 1: Demonstrate a thorough understanding of the key principles and practices essential for successful design entrepreneurship.

Performance Standards	Exceeds Expectations	Meets Expectations	Does not Meet Expectations
Marking Band	>80	55-79	<55
Ability to demonstrate understanding of design entrepreneurship principles and practices	Shows exceptional comprehension of entrepreneurial frameworks, creative industries, value creation, and foundational business principles. Demonstrates insightful connections between design and entrepreneurship with strong analytical reasoning.	Demonstrates adequate understanding of principles and practices. Can articulate concepts but may lack depth, integration, or strategic linkage across topics.	Displays limited or incorrect understanding of entrepreneurship concepts; explanations are superficial, inconsistent, or lack conceptual clarity.

CLO 2: Develop detailed and strategic business plans specifically tailored for design startups.

Performance Standards	Exceeds Expectations	Meets Expectations	Does not Meet Expectations
Marking Band	>80	55-79	<55
Ability to develop strategic business plans for design-driven ventures	Demonstrates deep, well-reasoned business planning with strong research integration, validated assumptions, strategic alignment, and a comprehensive business model. Elements are cohesive, logical, and venture-ready.	Business plan is structured and functional but may lack refinement, integration of insights, or thorough validation. Components may be developed individually but not strongly connected.	Business plan is incomplete, superficial, or lacks strategic direction. Weak logic, unclear market understanding, or missing essential components.

CLO 3: Apply innovative and creative thinking to generate unique design solutions and viable business ideas.

Performance Standards	Exceeds Expectations	Meets Expectations	Does not Meet Expectations
Marking Band	>80	55-79	<55
Ability to generate creative, strategic, and user-centred solutions	Demonstrates strong innovation through differentiated ideas, refined prototypes, compelling narratives, and strategic design-led venture thinking. Solutions reflect originality and depth.	Shows competent creativity; solutions are viable but may lack refinement, originality, or strong narrative integration. May miss full systems thinking.	Demonstrates minimal creativity; ideas lack originality, feasibility, coherence, or strategic grounding.

CLO 4: Acquire practical skills and knowledge necessary for the successful management and growth of a design startup.

Performance Standards	Exceeds Expectations	Meets Expectations	Does not Meet Expectations
Marking Band	>80	55-79	<55
Ability to apply design and business strategy for practical venture growth	Shows highly consistent venture logic, strong feasibility, validated assumptions, and excellent integration of design + business strategy. Demonstrates clear potential for scalability and real-world execution.	Applies design and business strategy adequately; startup concept is functional and coherent but may lack depth, sophistication, or clarity in growth pathways.	Shows inconsistent or weak strategic reasoning. Concept may be unviable, poorly aligned, or lacking clarity regarding scalability or operational feasibility.

Attendance & Punctuality

Learning is an interactive process. Students are expected to be present in all the classes. Absence is only appropriate in exceptional circumstances. Voluntary activities are never valid reasons for missing any class.

Students may refer to the student handbook for regulations covering attendance.

Students who do not meet attendance requirements will not be permitted to write the end term examination and will be required to repeat the course with the next batch of students.

Late arrival is disruptive to the learning environment; students are expected to be in class before the scheduled commencement time. Students arriving for class after the scheduled commencement time will be turned away unless they have a valid reason to be permitted to attend.

Copyright

The content provided by the faculty in the class is copy-righted. Students are instructed not to distribute or share content used during courses with external entities.

Student Code of Ethics

Each student enrolled in this course accepts personal responsibility to uphold and defend academic integrity and to promote an atmosphere in which all individuals may flourish. The Students' Code of Ethics strives to set a standard of honest behaviour that reflects well on students and the school. All students enrolled in these courses are expected to follow the Students' Code of Ethics contained in the student handbook. Unethical and unfair practices adopted by students may lead to penalties such as having to repeat the course or having the student's enrollment cancelled.

APPENDIX A: Opportunity Mapping Challenge

1. Objective

To analyse weak signals, behavioural shifts, and cultural patterns and synthesise them into coherent opportunity areas for early-stage venture development.

2. Brief Description

Students conduct exploratory research to identify signals, interpret user tensions, and cluster insights into meaningful patterns. The work demonstrates strategic thinking, analytical reasoning, and the ability to interpret complex environments to inform entrepreneurial decision-making.

3. Submission Requirements

- 12–15 slide PPT/PDF
- Signal scan (min. 10 weak signals)
- Cultural/behavioural/market observations
- Insight clusters (visual mapping required)
- Tensions and pain points
- 3–5 opportunity statements with rationale
- Visual matrices/frameworks
- Proper citation of sources

Criteria	Marks	Description
Reflective Thinking	5	Assesses the student's ability to interpret raw observations, identify patterns, and recognise deeper implications of signals within cultural or market contexts.

Conceptual Clarity	5	Evaluates clarity and precision in forming insights, identifying clusters and articulating opportunity spaces that are relevant, well-grounded, and strategically meaningful.
Documentation & Presentation	4	Measures the quality of visual representation, organisation of slides, and the ability to communicate complex information in a structured, easy-to-understand manner.
Problem Solving	1	Assesses the ability to derive actionable opportunity statements that respond to identified tensions or unmet needs.

APPENDIX B: MVP Sprint

1. Objective

To translate insights and opportunity areas into clear concept directions by developing quick MVPs that represent early versions of potential solutions.

Focus is on speed, clarity, user-centred design, and structured experimentation.

2. Brief Description

Students will work on preparing low-fidelity prototypes that express the core functionality or value of their idea. This includes user journeys, information flow, wireframes, simple prototypes, and early validation approaches. The sprint encourages:

- Rapid iteration
- Practical decision-making
- Early testing mindset
- Clear articulation of core value

Students demonstrate the ability to turn insights into tangible early outputs.

3. Submission Requirements

- **10–12 slide PDF/PPT**
- User persona(s)
- User journey map
- MVP definition
- Core features
- Low-fidelity prototype (sketches, wireframes, screens)
- Assumptions + Validation plan
- Initial learnings, next steps

Criteria	Marks	Description
Conceptual Clarity	5	Evaluates how clearly the student defines the MVP concept, including problem–solution alignment. Assesses the logic, relevance, and focus of the MVP in relation to identified insights.
Application of Methods	5	Assesses the use of UX/design tools such as user journeys, flows, prototyping, and assumption mapping. Measures how effectively these methods inform the MVP.
Documentation	5	Reviews clarity, layout, organisation, and completeness of slides. Evaluates how well the student communicates processes, prototypes, and rationale.

APPENDIX C: Design Venture Project

1. Objective

To develop a fully articulated, research-backed, design-driven venture that includes value proposition, business model, branding, prototype, and strategic roadmap.

2. Brief Description

This appendix represents the most comprehensive portion of the course, requiring students to build a cohesive venture system. The project synthesises research, strategy, creativity, and business thinking. Deliverables include:

- Opportunity analysis
- Personas & journeys
- Value proposition
- Business model
- Brand identity
- Prototypes
- GTM strategy
- Roadmap

Students demonstrate ability to think holistically and communicate ventures effectively.

3. Submission Requirements

- **40–70 slide PDF/PPT**
- Opportunity area (from Appendix A)
- Detailed research summary & insights
- Personas + journey maps
- Value proposition canvas
- Business Model Canvas
- Brand narrative + identity elements
- Prototype/MVP screens or artefacts
- GTM + growth strategy
- Roadmap (6M, 12M, 36M)
- References

Criteria	Marks	Description
Conceptual Clarity	10	Assesses the strength of the venture idea, including clarity of opportunity framing, articulation of value proposition, and overall strategic coherence. Evaluates how well research supports concept development.
Application of Methods	10	Evaluates proper use of design and entrepreneurial methodologies including research synthesis, BMC, branding, prototyping, and design strategy. Checks relevance, depth, and correctness of methods.
Documentation	10	Reviews professional quality of slides, structure, visual language, narrative continuity, and completeness of all components. Includes brand narrative, prototype artefacts, GTM strategy, and roadmap.

APPENDIX D: Final Pitch Deck Jury

1. Objective

To communicate the venture clearly and persuasively through a professional, structured pitch presentation demonstrating design, research, strategy, and entrepreneurial capability.

2. Brief Description

Students articulate their venture using a pitch deck and deliver it to a jury panel. Assessment includes clarity, storytelling, design communication, business soundness, confidence, and response during Q&A.

This develops public communication, persuasion skills, and the ability to defend design and business decisions.

3. Submission Requirements

- **12–20 slide Pitch Deck**
- 10–15 minute live presentation
- Q&A round

Criteria	Marks	Description
Product	15	Assesses the maturity of the venture output: clarity of concept, feasibility, integration of design and business decisions, and user-centricity.
Process & Reasoning	15	Evaluates how well students articulate their end-to-end process including research, insights, design reasoning, iterations, and strategic development.
Presentation & Delivery	5	Reviews clarity, structure, visual design, storytelling, and verbal communication during the pitch.
Personality & Confidence	5	Measures confidence, professionalism, audience engagement, and the ability to respond convincingly in Q&A.

Course Code: BDSE34606	Course Title: DESIGN ENTREPRENEURSHIP						
			L	T	P	O	Total Credits
			1	0	2	3	3
Objectives							
1. Understand Design Entrepreneurship Fundamentals: Equip students with a foundational understanding of the principles and practices of design entrepreneurship.							
2. Develop Business Planning Skills: Enable students to create comprehensive business plans tailored to design startups.							
3. Cultivate Innovation and Creativity: Foster innovation and creative thinking to develop unique design solutions and business ideas.							
4. Learn Practical Startup Management: Provide students with practical skills and knowledge for managing and scaling a design startup effectively.							
Outcomes							
CLO 1: Demonstrate a thorough understanding of the key principles and practices essential for successful design entrepreneurship.							
CLO 2: Develop detailed and strategic business plans specifically tailored for design startups.							
CLO 3: Apply innovative and creative thinking to generate unique design solutions and viable business ideas.							
CLO 4: Acquire practical skills and knowledge necessary for the successful management and growth of a design startup.							
Textbooks (T) per availability in library		NIL					
Reference Books (R)	R1	The Lean Startup: How Today's Entrepreneurs Use Continuous Innovation to Create Radically Successful Businesses by Eric Ries, 1st Edition.					
	R2	Creative Confidence: Unleashing the Creative Potential Within Us All by Tom Kelley and David Kelley, 1st Edition.					
	R3	Design a Better Business: New Tools, Skills, and Mindset for Strategy and Innovation by Patrick Van Der Pijl, Justin Lokitz, and Lisa Kay Solomon, 1st Edition.					
	R4	Business Model Generation: A Handbook for Visionaries, Game Changers, and Challengers by Alexander Osterwalder and Yves Pigneur, 1st Edition.					
	R5	Zero to One: Notes on Startups, or How to Build the Future by Peter Thiel and Blake Masters, 1st Edition.					
	R6	The Art of Innovation: Lessons in Creativity from IDEO, America's Leading Design Firm by Tom Kelley and Jonathan Littman, 1st Edition.					
	R7	The Start-up Owner’s Manual: The Step-By-Step Guide for Building a Great Company - Blank & Dorf.					

	R8	Business Model Generation, Alexander Osterwalder.			WOX UNIVE
Journal Articles (J) provide link only	J1	Nil			
Case Material/ Whitepaper provide link only					
Any Other Sources	O				
Modules					
Module No.	Topics			Total Contact Hours	CLO Mapping

1	Unit I: Foundations of Design Entrepreneurship This unit introduces the fundamental concepts of design entrepreneurship. Students will explore the principles and practices that are critical to launching and sustaining a design startup. Topics covered will include the definition and scope of design entrepreneurship, the role of innovation in design, and an overview of the entrepreneurial ecosystem. Through case studies and discussions, students will understand the characteristics and mindset of successful design entrepreneurs.	20	1
2	Unit II: Business Planning and Strategy Development In this unit, students will learn to create comprehensive business plans tailored to design startups. The unit will cover market research, competitive analysis, and the development of a unique value proposition. Students will also learn how to set realistic goals, outline business models, and create financial projections. Practical workshops will guide students through the process of drafting a business plan, ensuring they can translate their creative ideas into viable business strategies.	25	2
3	Unit III: Innovation and Creative Thinking This unit focuses on fostering innovation and creative thinking within the context of design entrepreneurship. Students will engage in activities and exercises that stimulate creative problem-solving and ideation. The unit will cover techniques for brainstorming, conceptual development, and the application of design thinking methodologies. Students will be encouraged to think outside the box and develop original design solutions and business concepts.	20	3

4	Unit IV: Practical Startup Management In this unit, students will gain practical skills and knowledge necessary for managing and scaling a design startup. Topics will include operations management, team building, leadership, and effective communication. Students will learn about the challenges of startup management and strategies for overcoming them. Additionally, the unit will cover the basics of marketing, branding, and customer relationship management, essential for growing a design business.	25	4 & 5
5	Unit V: Project Development and Pitch Presentation The final unit is dedicated to the development and presentation of a comprehensive design startup project. Students will apply the knowledge and skills acquired throughout the course to create a viable business plan for a design startup. They will work on refining their ideas, preparing pitch presentations, and practicing their delivery. The unit will culminate in a final pitch session where students present their startup projects to a panel of instructors and peers, receiving constructive feedback to refine their business ideas.		
Total Contact Hours		90	
Guest lecture / Expert sessions:			
Sl.No	Name of Resource Person	Module/Topics	Total Hours
1	B. Mithil Kumar & Shalaka Rupendra Gaikwad	Business Models, Narrative Building, Venture Strategy, Creative Startup Operations, GTM, Scaling a Design-Led Venture	16 Hours
Total Hours:			16 Hours
Recommended by Board of studies		DD/MM/YYYY	
Approved by Academic Council on		No:	DD/MM/YYYY

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Disclaimer: The Syllabus and the Course Outline is indicative of the body of knowledge a student should possess. It does not anyway be construed as a to be covered in class in as-is condition. Faculty may add, delete and modify content based on updated information or context.